



Figure 1: Kdenlive comes with five panes by default

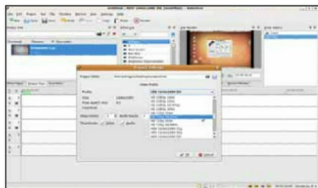


Figure 2: Selecting the video profile

projects and clips. The fourth window is 'Undo history' where you can see all the latest actions made by you, and you can also undo them. The last and the most important window is the timeline. This panel is what makes movies.

The timeline

You can drag your clips to the timeline. Here, you can right click and view all the options for what you can do with the clips (Figure 3). I would suggest you go for 'Split Audio' so that you have audio and video on separate tracks, which gives you more control over the editing procedure. You might wonder about the need for this. Well, let's assume you have taken a shot of a conference and you now want to add your commentary to it. You will need to cut out the live audio from the conference and add your layer of commentary. Moreover, you can also boost the audio if you want to show some response from the audience. It is always better to have independent control on your media.

Here, on the timeline, you can add as many audio and video tracks as you wish. Now, in case of the footage shot at an event, you might wish to make a documentary. You could also take pictures of interviews elsewhere, or of different stalls and activities. To put them together, avoid the same track -- this causes confusion and overlap. Always use different tracks for different locations/activities and then you can place them on the timeline according to your script.

Keep one track for the V/O (voice over) or your commentary and another track for background music. This way, you will have full control over your project and you will

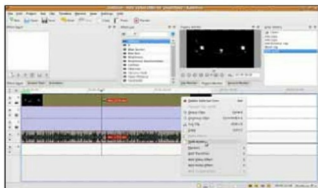


Figure 3: A right click gives you all the options for your current timeline



Figure 4: Cut and paste on the timeline

be able to edit shots easily without disturbing other clips. By right clicking a clip, you can also cut it and insert another clip (Figure 4), on a different track. You can also right click to add a 'Guide', which will be a horizontal line so that if your other clips are somewhere down the timeline, you can place them at the correct point. The beauty of Kdenlive is that, just like any other non-linear video editor, you can add, delete and insert clips anywhere on the whole timeline.

You can also select video transition effects from the second video to apply the right transitions. It could fade from black (good for the opening shot—see Figure 5) or you could also create 'title clips' by going to Project->Add Title Clip. Here, you can type the text, add the background, colour it, or do what ever you want. Once the clip is ready, save it and it will be visible in the 'Project Tree'. Just drag the clip to the desired place. You may also control the duration of the clip by simply stretching it.

Rendering

Now, all you have to do is render the video in your desired format (Figure 6). But here is the tricky part. There could be a lot of unused clips and audio files on your timeline and if you render this project, all that unwanted material will also get added to your film. So either remove those clips from the timeline or use the 'Lock Track' option to lock the tracks where they are on the timeline, so that they don't get moved while you are fiddling with other tracks. This is very important while rendering a project.

To render your project, look out for the green bar at